

Part G: Reconnaissance Report

Target Information

Field	Details
Website Name	National Informatics Centre (NIC)
Website URL	https://www.nic.in
Domain	nic.in
Target Type	Government Organization

WHOIS Results

A WHOIS lookup was performed to gather publicly available domain registration information. The domain **nic.in** is registered with the **National Informatics Centre**. The lookup provided the registration date, expiry date, domain status, and the authoritative name servers associated with the domain.

DNS Information

DNS enumeration was performed using the **nslookup** command. The results identified the domain's MX, NS, and TXT records. These records provide information about the website's mail servers, name servers, and domain verification records. No A record was found in the query performed.

Technologies Identified

Website technology identification showed that the NIC website uses **WordPress** as its Content Management System (CMS) and **PHP** as the server-side programming language. It also uses **HTTP/3**, **Tailwind CSS**, **jQuery**, **Google Analytics (GA4)**, and several other web technologies to improve performance and functionality.

Security Headers

The HTTP response headers indicate that the website implements important security mechanisms. Headers such as **Content-Security-Policy (CSP)**, **X-Frame-Options**, **X-Content-Type-Options**, **Strict-Transport-Security (HSTS)**, and **Referrer-Policy** are present, helping protect the website against common web attacks.

Robots.txt Findings

The website provides a publicly accessible **robots.txt** file, which contains instructions for search engine crawlers. However, no publicly accessible **sitemap.xml** file was found at the standard location.

Overall Observations

The reconnaissance process showed that the NIC website follows several good security practices. It uses modern web technologies, secure communication through HTTPS, properly configured DNS records, and important HTTP security headers. All information was collected using passive reconnaissance techniques without interacting with or affecting the target website.

Conclusion

During this reconnaissance activity, I learned how to gather publicly available information about a website using ethical and passive information-gathering techniques. By performing WHOIS lookup, DNS enumeration, website technology identification, HTTP security header analysis,

and robots.txt inspection, I gained a better understanding of the website's infrastructure and security posture. The National Informatics Centre (NIC) website uses modern technologies and implements several security best practices, including important HTTP security headers and secure DNS configuration. This practical demonstrated that valuable information can be collected without performing any intrusive actions. Overall, the exercise improved my understanding of the reconnaissance phase, which is an essential first step in cybersecurity assessments and penetration testing.